This is so thick and hearty it is a meal in itself—a real family soup. For children, try topping it with some broken-up tortilla chips.

mexican chili bean soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 10 MINS **COOK** 40 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
AT THE END OF STEP 2

2 tbsp sunflower oil
1 onion, chopped
1 small red bell pepper, seeded and finely chopped
2 garlic cloves, finely chopped
14oz (400g) lean ground beef
1 tsp ground cumin
2 tsp medium or hot chili powder
½ tsp dried oregano
1 x 14oz (400g) can chopped plum tomatoes
2 tbsp tomato purée
3¼ cups hot vegetable stock or chicken stock
1 x 14oz (400g) can red kidney beans, drained, rinsed, and drained again
handful of chopped flat-leaf parsley
salt and freshly ground black pepper
sour cream or natural yogurt, to serve
grated Cheddar, to serve
4 warm tortillas (optional), to serve

1 Heat the oil in a large saucepan, add the onion, and cook for 5 minutes. Add the pepper and garlic and stir-fry for 2 minutes. Add the beef and stir-fry for 5 minutes or until it has broken up and browned. Stir in the cumin, chili powder, and oregano and cook for another minute or so.

2 Stir in the tomatoes, tomato purée, and stock, then simmer for about 20–25 minutes or until reduced slightly and a good soupy consistency. Add the beans and simmer for another 5 minutes. Stir in half the parsley and season with salt and freshly ground black pepper.

3 Ladle into bowls and serve topped with a spoonful of sour cream or yogurt, a scattering of Cheddar, and the rest of the parsley.



RED KIDNEY BEANS
Valued for their color and the robust, sweet flavor they acquire during cooking, red kidney beans are sometimes known as chili beans. When buying them canned, go for organic beans preserved without salt or sugar.